

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



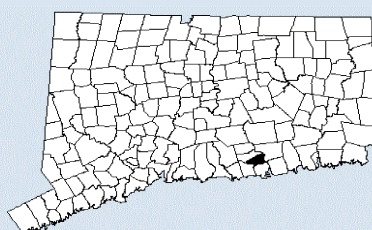
Essex School District

Brian White, Superintendent • 860-526-2417 • <http://www.reg4.k12.ct.us>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-6
Number of Schools/Programs	1
Enrollment	300
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$27,650
Total Expenditures ¹	\$8,433,297

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	6

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	132	44.0	48.3
Male	168	56.0	51.5
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.2
Asian	*	*	5.2
Black or African American	*	*	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	25	8.3	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	11	3.7	4.7
White	261	87.0	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	10	3.3	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	64	21.3	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	80	26.7	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	0	0.0
Male	*	*	12	6.7
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	0	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	*	*
White	*	*	*	*
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*	7	8.9
Students with Disabilities	*	*	6	6.3
District	14	5.2	12	3.8
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: Fewer than 6

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Essex School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	26.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	0.4
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	9.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	21.2
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	1.3
School Level	1.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	1.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	6.1
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	2.4
School Nurses	0.9
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	17.3

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.4
Black or African American	1	1.9	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	0	0.0	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	51	98.1	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	10.1	13.3

Instruction and Resources

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers²

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	6	*
Emotional Disability	*	*
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	18	75.0
Other Health Impairment	*	*
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	*	*
District	37	75.5
State		66.8

² This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Essex School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	9	3.5	2.6
Emotional Disability	*	*	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.6
Learning Disability	24	9.2	6.4
Other Health Impairment	*	*	3.5
Other Disabilities	*	*	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	10	3.8	2.0
All Disabilities	55	21.2	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$5,597,168	\$18,351	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$490,092	\$1,634	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$119,015	\$397	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$350,685	\$1,169	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$650,967	\$2,170	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$86,880	\$290	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$760,383	\$2,535	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$255,380	\$860	\$1,582
Food services	\$122,728	\$409	\$8
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$213
Total	\$8,433,297	\$27,650	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$410,170	21.8	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$412,889	21.9	10.2
Other Salaries	\$97,371	5.2	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$310,792	16.5	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$117,832	6.3	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$425,924	22.6	22.2
Supplies	\$14,101	0.7	0.7
Property Services	\$1,037	0.1	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$89,786	4.8	8.4
Equipment	\$2,462	0.1	0.3
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$1,882,364	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		22.3	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	95.3
State	2.1
Federal	2.6
Tuition & Other	.

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Essex School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Asian	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Hispanic or Latino of any race	12	*	12	*	*	*
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	7	*	7	*	*	*
White	127	77.8	127	75.4	31	81.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	7	*	7	*	*	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	141	77.6	141	75.1	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	30	66.0	30	63.3	13	*
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	118	78.9	118	76.5	28	81.1
Students with Disabilities	33	62.9	33	61.6	7	*
Students without Disabilities	115	80.2	115	77.4	34	82.0
High Needs	55	65.8	55	63.9	16	*
Non-High Needs	93	82.5	93	79.7	25	82.9
District	148	76.3	148	73.8	41	77.2

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	70.7	89.5	N/A	N/A	79	79.7
Curl Up	87.8	97.4	N/A	N/A	79	92.4
Push Up	73.2	86.8	N/A	N/A	79	79.7
Mile Run/PACER	63.4	86.8	N/A	N/A	79	74.7
All Tests - District	46.3	76.3	N/A	N/A	79	60.8
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Essex School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	76.3	75	50.0	50	100.0	63.9
	High Needs Students	65.8	75	43.9	50	87.7	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	73.8	75	49.2	50	98.4	60.2
	High Needs Students	63.9	75	42.6	50	85.3	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	77.2	75	50.0	50	100.0	61.8
	High Needs Students	.	75	.	.	.	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	59.6%	100%	59.6	100	59.6	58.7%
	High Needs Students	51.4%	100%	51.4	100	51.4	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	61.3%	100%	61.3	100	61.3	61.4%
	High Needs Students	61.0%	100%	61.0	100	61.0	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	.	100%	.	.	.	58.9%
	Oral	.	100%	.	.	.	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	5.2%	<=5%	49.6	50	99.2	17.7%
	High Needs Students	6.7%	<=5%	46.5	50	93.1	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	.	75%	.	.	.	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	.	75%	.	.	.	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		.	94%	.	.	.	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		.	75%	.	.	.	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		98.8% 60.8%	75%	40.5	50	81.0	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		.	60%	.	.	.	55.0%
Accountability Index				605.7	800	75.7	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	65.8	9.2	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	75.0	63.9	11.1	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	.	.	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	93.7
	High Needs Students	84.8
Math	All Students	93.7
	High Needs Students	84.8
Science	All Students	97.6
	High Needs Students	.

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: * **State: 49.7**

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Essex School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Essex Elementary School continues to focus on our mission to ensure that all students are achieving at high levels. Innovative, exemplary, and research-based programs, coupled with professional development, focused and aligned resources, and public participation in planning, are critical factors for our continuous growth. The School Improvement Plan for 2020-21 provided the focus for our staff in developing goals in the area of Social Emotional Learning. The School Improvement Committee met to analyze assessment data to determine strengths and areas of concern. All certified staff developed goals directly aligned with school goals. Each goal included instructional strategies and progress monitoring strategies to measure student growth and achievement throughout the year. Efforts are coordinated to provide seamless instruction between all professionals in the building for a continuum of instructional support for student growth. The Principal updates the public on progress being made on our goals. An early intervention process, SRBI, supports teacher and specialist collaboration for effective use of instructional resources and to monitor student progress. A core team, including reading specialists, math coach, support staff and administration, meet weekly to actively identify strategies to meet the needs of identified learners and progress monitor their interventions. Students with attendance issues are monitored through the SRBI process. Students in need of special education services are supported through an inclusion and co-teaching model. Additional behavior supports and other research-based interventions are also provided for students with specialized educational needs.

Parents and community members are important partners in our school. Parents are part of the Social Development Core Team, EES Foundation and the PTO. Professional staff support families in a variety of ways. All families receive an electronic student handbook listing and describing important policies and procedures for the school. A Curriculum Night is held for families each year where teachers share their grade level curriculum to foster a strong home-school partnership. Parent-Teacher conferences are held to inform parents of their child's academic progress, twice per year. The EES Stakeholder Goal embraced by all staff provided opportunities and support to partner with families and strengthen the home-school connections. Each month a multi-page school newsletter is sent home to parents and each week an email "blast" is sent home. Teachers post homework and other information on their webpages, Google Classrooms and use phone and email communication to keep families informed of their child's educational program. Board of Education meeting minutes, District Goals, Mission Statement, Core Beliefs, Strategic Goals and Action Statements, Board Policies and a calendar of events are also posted and updated on the district and school website.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Essex Elementary School continues its work to reduce its relative racial, ethnic and economic isolation. The PTO provides a strong cultural arts program for K-6 students. The Cultural Arts program focuses content on the visiting performers by exposing students to a variety of cultures and traditions through dance, music, puppetry and storytelling. In various performances throughout the year, performers represented different cultures. The EES Foundation typically sponsors the World Cultures program for students in grade 2 with guests from Haiti, India and China who share their culture's music, art, food and historical activities. EES provides a weekly experience in Spanish for students in grades three-six (FLES-Foreign Language in the Elementary School) in which students develop their vocabulary and conversational skills, as well as learn about the traditions and current practices of Spanish-speaking cultures around the world. Students in grades one and two also enjoy Spanish lessons by our certified Spanish teacher. Our Social Development Program promotes a school culture, climate, and curriculum that fosters social, emotional, and behavioral development and wellness of students. A major focus of the program and curriculum is to develop students' tolerance for others, to regulate their own emotions, and to celebrate differences among all people. Our Book of the Month program embeds our core values into the general curriculum in each classroom as part of our Social Development Program, school wide.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Essex School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Essex town and school budget allocates resources to ensure equity and address needs each year, primarily during the budget process. The budget development process for Essex Elementary School ensures equitable allocation of resources based on student needs across the school. School and central office administrators develop a proposed budget for the school collaboratively. Specifically, the process begins with a student enrollment projection to determine instructional needs to support student instruction, including but not limited to, staffing, textbooks, instructional supplies, and library media supplies. Analyses of expenditures from the previous school year are conducted. The analyses include a review of instructional versus non-instructional costs, the study of budgeted vs. actual expenditures, impact on facilities, etc. The budget is reviewed to ensure that it corresponds with requirements of statutes, educational goals, district policies, and collective bargaining agreements. The school budgets are combined to develop a budget that is presented to the citizens of the town for approval.